

SIH26162

Team Leader Study Guide

AI-Based Detection and Classification of Industrial Fires and Persistent Thermal Sources
Using NASA FIRMS, OSM & Satellite Data

Sponsor context: NTRO | Smart India Hackathon 2026 | Team ZeroOne

A personal technical handbook: go from "I barely understand this project" to "I can explain, defend, debug and present the whole system to judges."

HOW TO READ THIS

Every technical concept has four lines: **ELI5**, **OUR BUILD**, **WHY**, **MEMORY**.

Status tags are used everywhere. Do not present a [PLANNED] feature as finished.

Tag	Meaning
[IMPLEMENTED]	Works today in the repo you can run right now.
[PLANNED]	In the approved plan / architecture.md, not yet coded.
[OPTIONAL]	Works only if an extra thing (e.g. an API key) is present; not required.
[NOT SUPPORTED]	Deliberately excluded. Must never be claimed.

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Part 1 — The Project in One Page

The project in one sentence

REMEMBER

We take NASA satellite heat detections over India, add industrial and geographic context, use a Random Forest to say whether each detection looks like a *persistent industrial source* or a *natural fire* (and flag the ones that fit neither as an *anomaly*), score how concerning it is, raise a prioritised, explained alert on a GIS dashboard, and let an operator ask questions about it in plain English.

Problem statement, in simple language

Satellites see **where** something hot is on the ground. They do **not** tell you what it is — a refinery flare, a steel plant, a forest fire, and stubble burning can all look similar in the raw feed. SIH26162 asks us to **separate industrial fires and persistent industrial thermal sources from natural / agricultural fires**, and to deliver it as a **GIS solution** (data stored and shown as map overlays).

Our solution (3–5 lines)

- Ingest NASA FIRMS thermal detections for India. [IMPLEMENTED]
- Enrich every detection with features: brightness temperature, FRP, persistence, day/night, distance to the nearest industrial facility, agri-season, land-cover zone. [IMPLEMENTED]
- Classify with a Random Forest (trained on global data, India held out) into A / B_candidate; flag low-confidence rows as anomalies. [IMPLEMENTED]
- Score risk (0–100) with a transparent rule engine, assign severity, raise alerts with a lifecycle, show them on a dark operations dashboard + India map + GIS export. [IMPLEMENTED]
- Reorganise the UI into clear sections and add a read-only natural-language **Fire Intelligence Agent**. [PLANNED]

THE MASTER MEMORY — the whole system as one chain

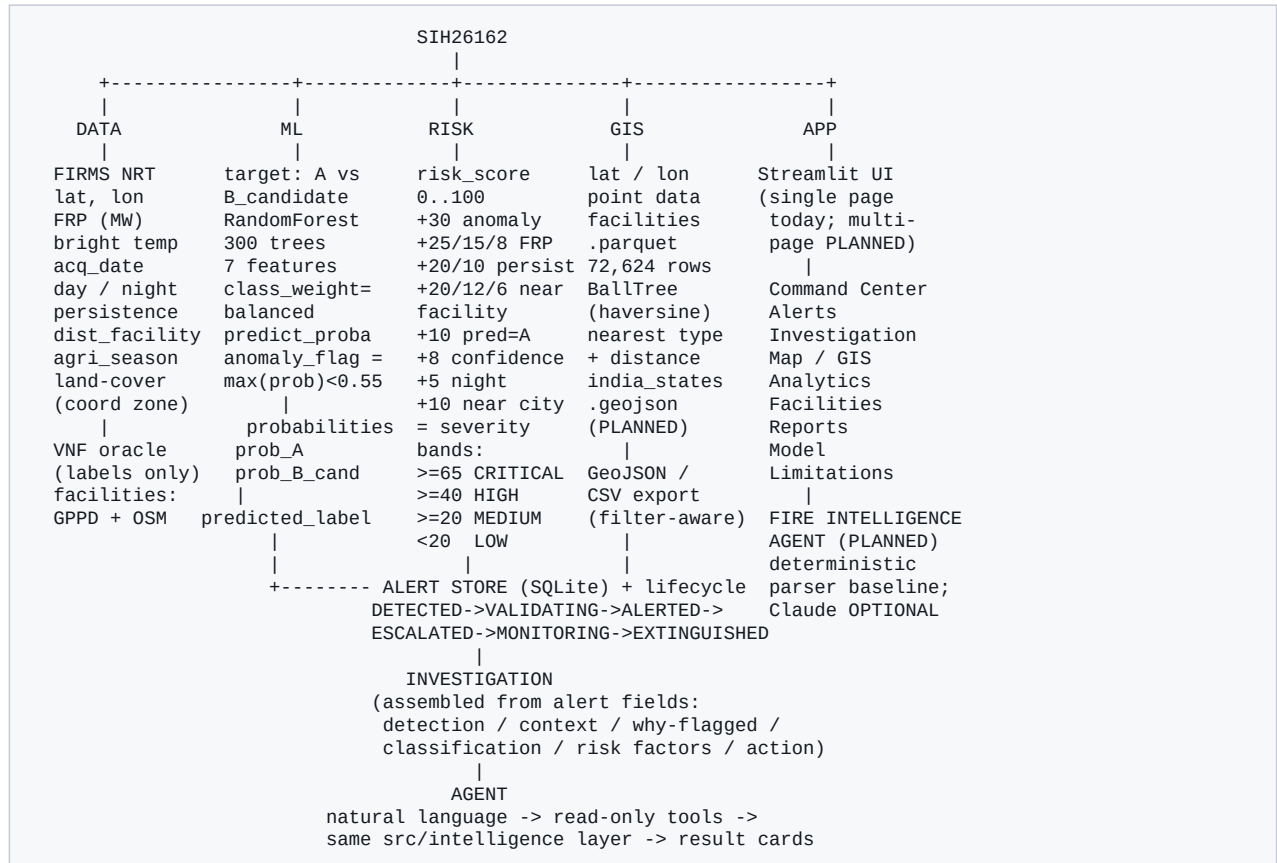
```
Satellite sensor detects heat on the ground
|
NASA FIRMS turns it into a DETECTION row (lat, lon, FRP, BT, time, day/night)
|
We ingest + clean it (src/ingestion/) [IMPLEMENTED]
|
We add ENVIRONMENTAL + INDUSTRIAL context [IMPLEMENTED]
(persistence count, nearest facility + distance, agri-season, land-cover zone)
|
ML (Random Forest) estimates WHAT the thermal event is [IMPLEMENTED]
-> predicted_label in {A, B_candidate} + probabilities + anomaly_flag
|
RISK ENGINE estimates HOW CONCERNING it is [IMPLEMENTED]
-> risk_score 0-100 -> severity CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW -> narrative
|
GIS tells us WHERE it is and WHAT is nearby [IMPLEMENTED]
-> map marker, facility context, GeoJSON/CSV export
|
ALERT is generated + stored in SQLite with a lifecycle [IMPLEMENTED]
|
OPERATOR investigates the alert (why was this flagged?) [PLANNED page]
|
AGENT helps the operator ask questions in natural language [PLANNED]
```

REMEMBER

Two verbs to never mix up: the **ML classifies** (what is it?), the **risk engine scores** (how much should I care?). They are different code, different logic.

Part 2 — Master Mind Map

Look at this for 30 seconds. It is the entire project.



REMEMBER

DATA feeds ML and GIS. ML + GIS feed the RISK engine and the ALERT. The ALERT feeds the DASHBOARD. The DASHBOARD is what the AGENT and the operator both drive.

Part 3 — Problem Statement

ELI5

Imagine a smoke alarm for the whole country, seen from space. It beeps whenever anything is hot. It cannot tell you if the hot thing is a factory doing its normal job, a factory on fire, or a farmer burning crop stubble. Our job is to be the person standing next to the alarm who says: "that one is a normal factory... that one is a crop fire... that one is weird, someone should go look."

Technical explanation

- **What SIH26162 asks:** (i) classify and segregate industrial fires from forest/natural fires; (ii) a GIS-based solution for storage + visualisation as map overlays. (from the dashboard docstring & `context.md`)
- **Why thermal anomalies matter:** industrial fires near refineries, chemical plants, power stations and mines threaten life, infrastructure and the environment; persistent-source monitoring supports compliance and activity intelligence.
- **Why facilities matter:** a hotspot's *meaning* depends on context — the same brightness reading 200 m from a refinery vs. in a forest are very different situations. Distance-to-facility is our strongest single feature (importance 0.29).
- **Why satellites alone are not enough:** NASA states MODIS/VIIRS active-fire products do *not* attribute anomaly type (fire vs flare vs volcano). A raw hotspot is never a labelled example of anything.

What NASA FIRMS gives us / does not give us

FIRMS PROVIDES	FIRMS DOES NOT PROVIDE
lat, lon of a thermal anomaly	the cause (fire? flare? kiln? volcano?)
brightness temperature (K)	a confirmed-fire label
Fire Radiative Power, FRP (MW)	industrial vs natural distinction
acquisition date + time	history older than ~5 days (NRT only)
day / night flag, confidence	sub-pixel detail (375 m / 1 km pixels)

REMEMBER

FIRMS gives us DETECTIONS, not complete explanations. Our system is the layer of intelligence that turns a detection into a decision.

How to explain this to a judge in 30 seconds

EXAMPLE

"Satellites like NASA's FIRMS see heat anywhere on Earth, but they can't say what's burning. For an industrial region that's a problem: a refinery flare and a refinery fire look similar from orbit. We add industrial and geographic context to every detection, use a Random Forest trained on global data to separate persistent industrial sources from natural fires, flag the ones that match neither, score the risk, and put it on a GIS dashboard an operator can actually act on."

Part 4 — Data Pipeline

Our actual pipeline, stage by stage. Files are real paths in the repo.

```

[1] ACQUIRE          [2] INGEST          [3] CLEAN
NASA FIRMS NRT -->   raw CSV/parquet --> normalise columns, parse dates,
(India + 6 global)   tag split at ingest resolve BT column, sanity-check coords
VNF, GPPD, OSM      |
                    v
[4] FEATURE ENGINEER --> [5] FACILITY CONTEXT --> [6] CLASSIFY
bt_kelvin, frp_mw,    BallTree haversine   RandomForest ->
persistence_count,    nearest facility ->   predicted_label (A / B_candidate)
day_night_bin,        dist_nearest_facility_km + prob_A + prob_B_candidate
agri_season_flag,     + nearest_facility_type
acq_month             |
                    v
                    [7] CONFIDENCE / ANOMALY
                    anomaly_flag = max(prob) < 0.55
                    |
                    v
[8] PERSISTENCE (already a feature: re-lit 1km cell) [9] ALERT GENERATION
|                                                    risk_engine.score_dataframe ->
+-----> risk_score, severity, narrative,
land_cover_context ->
alert_store.insert_alerts (SQLite)

```

Stage-by-stage

Stage	What / Why	In -> Out	File	Status
1 Acquire	Download FIRMS NRT (India + 6 non-India regions), VNF flare catalogue, GPPD + OSM facilities. Needed as raw material.	HTTP API -> raw CSV/parquet in data/raw/	src/ingestion/firms.py, vnf.py, facilities.py	[IMPLEMENTED]
2 Ingest	Write raw files, tag each row split (train_global / validation_global / india_holdout) at ingest time so it can't be faked later.	raw response -> tagged parquet	src/ingestion/*, src/model/split.py	[IMPLEMENTED]
3 Clean	Normalise MODIS/VIIRS columns, pick the brightness-temp column, parse acq_date, coordinate checks.	raw parquet -> tidy rows	src/features/engineer.py	[IMPLEMENTED]
4 Feature engineer	Compute the 7 model features + extras per detection.	tidy rows -> features_stage4.parquet (25 cols, ~419k rows)	src/features/engineer.py	[IMPLEMENTED]
5 Facility context	For each detection find the nearest facility (BallTree, haversine) -> distance + type. Context, never a label.	detection + facilities.parquet -> dist_nearest_facility_km, nearest_facility_type	src/features/engineer.py_query_nearest_facility	[IMPLEMENTED]
6 Classify	Random Forest predicts A vs B_candidate + probabilities.	7 features -> predicted_label, prob_A, prob_B_candidate	src/model/train.py (model), stage6_india_scores.parquet (output)	[IMPLEMENTED]
7 Confidence / anomaly	If the top probability < 0.55 the model is unsure -> anomaly_flag = 1.	probabilities -> anomaly_flag	src/model/train.py:59,101-109	[IMPLEMENTED]
8 Persistence	Count how many times the same ~1 km cell was re-detected in the window (the strongest physical discriminator per the literature).	detections -> persistence_count	src/features/engineer.py:99-109,326-343	[IMPLEMENTED]

Stage	What / Why	In -> Out	File	Status
9 Alert generation	Rule-based risk score + severity + narrative + land-cover; insert into SQLite with an initial lifecycle status.	scored rows -> data/alerts.db	src/alerting/risk_engine.py, alert_store.py, pipeline.py	[IMPLEMENTED]

The data fields we actually use — one line each

Field	One-line meaning
latitude / longitude	Where on Earth the hot pixel is.
frp_mw	Fire Radiative Power in megawatts — how much heat energy the fire is radiating.
bt_kelvin	Brightness temperature of the pixel in Kelvin (FIRMS 4 um channel, ~300-500 K).
acq_date / acq_month	When the satellite saw it; month drives the agri-season flag.
day_night / day_night_bin	Was it a day or night pass; encoded 1=day, 0=night.
persistence_count	How many times that same ~1 km cell re-lit in the detection window.
land_cover_context	Coarse land-use zone from a coordinate rule (industrial / cropland / forest / mining / coastal).
nearest_facility_type	Category of the closest industrial site (refinery, power plant, steel, mine...).
dist_nearest_facility_km	Straight-line distance to that closest facility.
prob_A / prob_B_candidate	Random Forest probability for each of the two classes (sum to 1).
predicted_label	The class the model picked: 'A' or 'B_candidate'.
anomaly_flag	1 if max(prob_A, prob_B_candidate) < 0.55 — model can't confidently pick either pattern.
risk_score	0-100 number from the rule engine; NOT from the ML model.
severity	CRITICAL / HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW band derived from risk_score.

Part 5 — NASA FIRMS (our data source)

ELI5	FIRMS is NASA's free feed of "something is hot here" pings from weather satellites.
OUR BUILD	We pull FIRMS NRT (near-real-time, last ~5 days) for the India bounding box (lat 6-37, lon 68-97.5) plus 6 non-India regions for training. <code>src/ingestion/firms.py</code> .
WHY	It's global, free, no access restriction, and it's exactly the data the problem statement names.
MEMORY	FIRMS = free eyes in the sky. It sees heat, not meaning.

Key FIRMS terms

Term	Meaning in our project
Thermal anomaly	A pixel measurably hotter than its surroundings — a 'detection'. Not necessarily a fire.
FRP (Fire Radiative Power)	Rate of radiated heat energy in MW. Higher FRP -> more intense thermal event. Feature <code>frp_mw</code> ; risk +25/+15/+8 at ≥ 30 / ≥ 15 / ≥ 5 MW.
Brightness temperature	Apparent temperature of the pixel from its infrared radiance (K). Feature <code>bt_kelvin</code> . FIRMS pixel BT (~300-500 K) is a different quantity from VNF flame temp (1500-2000 K).
Day / night flag	Which satellite overpass. Night detections are less polluted by solar noise; risk +5 for night.
Confidence	FIRMS' own low/nominal/high (or 0-100). risk +8 when high.
NRT vs archive	We use NRT only (~5 days). Historical archive is [NOT SUPPORTED yet] — this is why our timeline depth and incident date-matching are limited.

REMEMBER

FIRMS gives us DETECTIONS, not complete explanations. Everything 'intelligent' in the project is what WE add on top: context, classification, risk, GIS, alerts.

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: Why FIRMS and not your own satellite / another dataset?

A: It is the dataset the problem statement specifies, it is global, free, needs only a free API key, and it is the operational standard for active-fire monitoring. We hold India out of training and use the rest of the world's FIRMS data to learn the physical patterns.

Part 6 — Feature Engineering

The model sees ONLY these 7 numbers per detection (src/model/train.py:49-57). Nothing else.

Feature	Meaning	Why it helps	Example
bt_kelvin	4 um pixel brightness temperature (K)	Industrial heat vs vegetation fire sit in different (overlapping) temperature ranges	~330 K
frp_mw	Fire Radiative Power (MW)	Intensity; very high or very low FRP shifts the likely cause	9.5
persistence_count	Re-detections of the same ~1 km cell in the window	A flare/kiln re-lights every pass; a wildfire is bursty. Best physical discriminator	4
dist_nearest_facility_km	Distance to nearest known industrial site	Industrial context. Our #1 feature (importance 0.29)	0.8
agri_season_flag	1 if month in {10,11,4,5,7,8,9,1,2}	Crop-residue burning is seasonal; helps tag Class B	1
day_night_bin	1 = day, 0 = night	Night persistence points to a continuous industrial source. Importance 0.25	0
acq_month	Calendar month 1-12	Seasonality signal (currently 0 importance — NRT window not in burning season)	8

RAW FIRMS ROW	ENGINEERED FEATURES	MODEL INPUT
latitude, longitude	dist_nearest_facility_km	---
bright_ti4 (K)	bt_kelvin	
frp	frp_mw	X = [7 floats]
acq_date	acq_month, agri_season_flag	+--> SimpleImputer
daynight	day_night_bin	(median)
(many rows, 1km cells)	persistence_count	---> RandomForest
+ facilities.parquet	nearest_facility_type (context, not a model input)	

ELI5	We turn messy satellite rows into a tidy list of 7 numbers the model can compare.
OUR BUILD	src/features/engineer.py builds a 25-column table; src/model/assemble.py keeps the 7 model columns and encodes day/night.
WHY	Models need consistent numeric inputs; the same 7 features must exist at India inference time, so we only use FIRMS-native quantities.
MEMORY	Raw data -> Features -> Model. The model never sees the raw row.

WATCH OUT

Facility **distance** is a feature. Facility proximity is **never** used as a label. 'Near a factory' does not mean 'industrial fire'.

Part 7 — Machine Learning

What the model actually is

Question	Answer (from the code)
Target classification	2 classes: A = persistent industrial thermal source; B_candidate = natural / agricultural fire.
Labels come from	VNF spatial oracle: a global FIRMS row within 5 km of a known VIIRS Nightfire gas-flare site -> 'A'; every other global FIRMS row -> 'B_candidate'. NO confirmed-incident labels.
Features	bt_kelvin, frp_mw, persistence_count, dist_nearest_facility_km, agri_season_flag, day_night_bin, acq_month.
Model	sklearn Pipeline: SimpleImputer(median) -> RandomForestClassifier(n_estimators=300, min_samples_leaf=10, class_weight='balanced', random_state=42).
Training samples	270,238 rows (A=1,655 / B_candidate=268,583).
Validation samples	64,864 rows (A=246 / B_candidate=64,618) — spatial grid holdout.
India inference	705 held-out India rows scored -> stage6_india_scores.parquet.
Outputs per row	predicted_label, prob_A, prob_B_candidate, anomaly_flag.

Why Random Forest

- Tabular data with 7 features — trees are the natural fit, not deep nets.
- **Explainability** — we can show feature importance and per-alert reasoning to judges (the code comment literally says "explainability priority over accuracy").
- Robust to unscaled features, missing values (with the imputer), and heavy class imbalance (class_weight='balanced').
- Tiny positive class (~1,900 'A' rows) — deep learning would overfit.

```
DATA (labelled global FIRMS rows)
|
FEATURES (7 numbers, median-imputed)
|
RANDOM FOREST (300 decision trees, each votes)
|
PREDICTED LABEL <-- majority vote: 'A' or 'B_candidate'
|
PROBABILITIES <-- vote share: prob_A + prob_B_candidate = 1
|
CONFIDENCE / ANOMALY <-- if max(prob) < 0.55 -> anomaly_flag = 1
```

EXAMPLE

Random Forest = asking 300 slightly-different decision-makers the same question and taking the combined vote. If the vote is close (no side $\geq 55\%$), we don't force an answer — we call it an anomaly for a human to review.

The 0.55 threshold (it IS in the code)

ANOMALY_THRESHOLD = 0.55 in src/model/train.py:59 and src/scoring/score_incidents.py:46.
anomaly_flag = int(max(prob_A, prob_B_candidate) < 0.55). It is a fixed rule, not a learned parameter, and it is applied *after* the forest votes.

Evaluation metrics we obtained (from reports/stage6_evaluation.txt)

Evaluation	Accuracy	Class A P / R / F1	B_candidate P / R / F1
Random split (inflated benchmark)	0.9725	0.14 / 0.80 / 0.24	1.00 / 0.97 / 0.99
Spatial holdout (HONEST — saved model)	0.9806	0.11 / 0.57 / 0.18	1.00 / 0.98 / 0.99
India geographic holdout (no labels)	n/a	predicted A=309, B_candidate=396	anomaly 59 / 705 = 8.4%

Leakage gap: overall accuracy barely moves, but **Class A F1 drops 0.24 -> 0.18** when the split respects spatial grouping — that drop is the honest signal that random splitting leaks. Feature importance: dist_nearest_facility_km 0.29, day_night_bin 0.25, bt_kelvin 0.21, persistence_count 0.14, frp_mw 0.10, agri_season_flag 0, acq_month 0.

What the model does NOT claim

WATCH OUT

It never says "confirmed industrial fire". There is no dataset of confirmed industrial fires anywhere. The model separates two *learned patterns*; a real industrial incident often matches neither, so it is surfaced as an **anomaly for human review**.

Judge questions you must answer

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: Why Random Forest, why not deep learning / a CNN?

A: 7 tabular features and a ~0.6% positive class. Trees fit tabular data, need no scaling, handle imbalance with class weights, and are explainable. A CNN needs image inputs and far more labelled data than exists. We chose explainability over a marginal accuracy gain.

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: What are your labels and are they ground truth?

A: They are proxy labels, and we say so. 'A' = FIRMS row within 5 km of a VIIRS Nightfire gas-flare site; 'B_candidate' = other global FIRMS. No confirmed-fire labels exist. That's the core scientific honesty of the project.

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: How do you evaluate it?

A: Three ways side by side: random split (0.9725, inflated), spatial-grid holdout (0.9806, honest), and India geographic holdout (no labels, distribution + 8.4% anomaly rate). We report the gap, not hide it.

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: How accurate is the model, really?

A: Overall accuracy ~98% is dominated by the easy majority class. The honest number is Class A F1 = 0.18 on spatial holdout — the minority class is hard because we only have ~1,900 positive examples. Adding a historical FIRMS archive or GIHS would improve it.

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: What happens when the model is uncertain?

A: If neither class reaches 0.55 probability, anomaly_flag = 1 and the detection is presented as 'Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event' — explicitly a candidate for human verification, not a conclusion.

JUDGE QUESTION

Q: Can you guarantee an alert is a real fire?

A: No, and we never claim it. Every alert requires human verification. We detect anomalous departures from known patterns.

Part 8 — Classification vs Risk (critical distinction)



EXAMPLE

The ML might say "this looks like Class A (persistent source), prob 0.72". The risk engine independently says "FRP 40 MW + 4 repeat detections + 0.8 km from a refinery + near a city = risk 82 = CRITICAL". One tells you the *type*, the other tells you the *urgency*.

REMEMBER

Classification != Risk. A correctly-classified routine flare can be LOW risk. An anomaly near a chemical plant is CRITICAL risk. Judges love this distinction — it shows the system is operational, not just a classifier.

How the 3 dashboard classes are produced

```
# src/alerting/risk_engine.py (score_row)
if anomaly_flag == 1:      output_class = "Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event"
elif predicted_label == "A": output_class = "Persistent Industrial Thermal Source"
else:                     output_class = "Forest / Agricultural Fire"
```

So the model predicts 2 classes; the third ("Industrial Fire") is the anomaly bucket, assigned by a rule, not by the model.

Part 9 — Risk Engine

Everything here is literally in `src/alerting/risk_engine.py` function `score_row`. Start at 0, add points:

Signal (actual condition)	Points added
<code>anomaly_flag == 1</code>	+30
<code>frp_mw >= 30 / >= 15 / >= 5</code>	+25 / +15 / +8
<code>persistence_count >= 4 / >= 2</code>	+20 / +10
<code>dist_nearest_facility_km < 1 / < 5 / < 15</code>	+20 / +12 / +6
<code>predicted_label == 'A'</code>	+10
FIRMS confidence is high ('h' / 'high' / >= 70)	+8
<code>day_night == 'N' (night)</code>	+5
<code>nearest major city < 30 km</code>	+10

Severity bands (score -> band)

Band	Score	Meaning
CRITICAL	>= 65	Anomalous + persistent + near facility/population
HIGH	>= 40	Anomalous OR high FRP OR persistent near infrastructure
MEDIUM	>= 20	Moderate signal — monitor
LOW	< 20	Single low-confidence detection

Also produced by the risk engine (not ML)

- **land_cover_context** — coordinate-zone rule: 'Industrial Land Use' if <2 km & persistence>=2; else cropland / forest / mining corridor / coastal / mixed zones by lat-lon box.
- **hazard_facility_type** — maps the raw facility type string to one of: Oil Refinery / Petrochemical, Thermal Power Plant, Steel / Metal, Mining / Extraction, LNG / Gas Terminal, Chemical / Pharmaceutical, Brick Kiln / Ceramic, Nuclear Power Plant, or generic Industrial Facility.
- **narrative** — a plain-English sentence assembled from whichever signals fired (e.g. "Pattern anomaly ... FRP 40 MW ... 4 repeat detections ... <=0.8 km from Oil Refinery / Petrochemical ... Land cover: Industrial Land Use").
- **nearest_city, dist_nearest_city_km, near_population** — from a hard-coded list of 30 Indian cities in `risk_engine.py`.
- **risk factor breakdown** — [PLANNED] additive list of (reason, +points) for the Investigation view.

```
THERMAL DETECTION (scored FIRMS row)
|
EVIDENCE (only signals that are actually true)
|-- anomaly_flag == 1           (+30)
|-- frp_mw = 40 -> >= 30       (+25)
|-- persistence_count = 4 -> >= 4 (+20)
|-- dist_nearest_facility_km = 0.8 (+20)
|-- predicted_label 'A'         (+10) [example numbers]
|
RISK SCORE = 30+25+20+20+10 = 105 -> clamped view 100
|
SEVERITY = CRITICAL    (>= 65)
|
ALERT    (inserted into SQLite; CRITICAL/HIGH start at status ALERTED)
```

Alert lifecycle (alert_store.py LIFECYCLE_STATES)

State	What it means	How it is reached
DETECTED	New low-severity alert, not yet acted on	Initial status for LOW
VALIDATING	System/analyst confirming it's real	Initial status for MEDIUM
ALERTED	Raised for attention	Initial status for CRITICAL / HIGH
ESCALATED	Pushed up for field verification	Analyst clicks 'Escalate'
MONITORING	Acknowledged, being watched	Analyst clicks 'Acknowledge' (sets acknowledged_at)
EXTINGUISHED	Closed / resolved	Analyst clicks 'Resolve'

REMEMBER

Initial status is set by severity: CRITICAL/HIGH -> ALERTED, MEDIUM -> VALIDATING, LOW -> DETECTED. Only a human moves it further. The agent [PLANNED] is read-only and cannot.

Part 10 — "Why Was This Flagged?" (Investigation)

[PLANNED] as a dedicated page (`queries.get_investigation(alert_id)`); today the same information exists in the alert row + expander of the single-page app. It is **assembled from existing alert fields** — nothing new is invented.

DETECTION	acq_date/time, satellite = VIIRS 375m, FIRMS confidence
LOCATION	lat/lon, nearest city + state, land-cover zone
THERMAL EVIDENCE	frp_mw, bt_kelvin, persistence_count, day/night
INDUSTRIAL CONTEXT	dist_nearest_facility_km, hazard_facility_type
MODEL RESULT	predicted_label, prob_A, prob_B_candidate, anomaly_flag
RISK FACTORS	the +points signals that actually fired [PLANNED breakdown]
RISK SCORE	0-100 -> SEVERITY band
RECOMMENDED ACTION	derived string, e.g. "ESCALATE FOR FIELD VERIFICATION"

Why flagged — checklist rule

Each line shows ONLY if the underlying value is real: repeat detections (persistence ≥ 2), near industrial facility (distance below threshold), industrial land-use match, elevated FRP (above training median), night-time detection, pattern anomaly. False or unknown signals are omitted — never shown as an empty checkbox, never fabricated.

EXAMPLE

[EXAMPLE — illustrative, not a stored alert] Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event, near Paradip, Odisha. RISK 78/100, model class probability 0.52, status ALERTED. Detection: FRP 9.5 MW, 4 repeat detections, night pass, VIIRS 375 m. Context: 0.8 km from an Oil Refinery / Petrochemical facility; land cover Industrial Land Use. Why flagged: repeat detections; near industrial facility; industrial land-use match; night-time detection; pattern anomaly. Recommended action: ESCALATE FOR FIELD VERIFICATION — persistent high-intensity anomaly near industrial infrastructure.

REMEMBER

Don't just say WHAT we detected. Explain WHY the system thinks it matters. Explainability is a scoring criterion for SIH judges.

Part 11 — GIS / Geospatial Intelligence

ELI5	Every detection is a pin on a map, and we can measure how far that pin is from anything else.
OUR BUILD	pydeck ScatterplotLayer on a Carto dark basemap (no Mapbox token). Points coloured by class or severity; incident + facility layers; GeoJSON/CSV export. State/region resolver is [PLANNED] (bundled india_states.geojson + pure-Python point-in-polygon).
WHY	Geographic context is how we separate industrial activity from unrelated heat — the same reading means different things in an industrial corridor vs a forest.
MEMORY	Coordinates + nearest facility + zone = geographic context.

Concept	In our project
latitude / longitude	Decimal degrees; the primary key of a detection.
Point data	Each detection/alert is a single Point feature.
GeoJSON	Export format: a FeatureCollection of Points, each with the full alert attribute table. actions.export_geojson [PLANNED] / _alerts_to_geojson [IMPLEMENTED in app.py].
State detection	[PLANNED] point-in-polygon against a simplified India state GeoJSON -> 'Odisha', 'Jharkhand', ...
Region detection	[PLANNED] REGIONS map, e.g. 'eastern india' = {Odisha, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Bihar, ...}.
Facility proximity	BallTree (haversine) nearest-neighbour to facilities.parquet -> distance + type.
Map layers	detections (class/severity colour), confirmed incidents, facilities toggle, legend, tooltips.

```

DETECTION
|
COORDINATES (lat, lon)
|
NEAREST FACILITY (BallTree haversine over 72,624 facilities)
|
FACILITY TYPE + DISTANCE (e.g. "Oil Refinery / Petrochemical", 0.8 km)
|
GEOGRAPHIC CONTEXT (+ land-cover zone, + nearest city, + [PLANNED] state)
|
MAP (pydeck marker, colour = class, click -> Investigation [PLANNED])

```

REMEMBER

The map answers exactly one question well: WHERE are the thermal anomalies? Don't drown it in every attribute at once.

Part 12 — Our Facility Data

ELI5	We keep a giant list of industrial places. For every heat detection we ask: which industrial place is closest, and how far?
OUR BUILD	data/processed/facilities.parquet — 72,624 rows (34,936 from WRI Global Power Plant DB + 37,688 from OpenStreetMap landuse=industrial). Columns: facility_id, lat, lon, facility_type, source, name, country. ~39,277 rows are in India.
WHY	Distance-to-facility is our single most important model feature (importance 0.29) and a major risk signal (+20/+12/+6).
MEMORY	Big list of factories + nearest-neighbour search = industrial context.

How proximity is computed (the BallTree pattern — it IS used)

```
# src/features/engineer.py _query_nearest_facility (also score_incidents.py)
from sklearn.neighbors import BallTree
coords_rad = np.radians(facilities[["lat","lon"]].values)
tree = BallTree(coords_rad, metric="haversine") # build once
dist_rad, idx = tree.query(np.radians(points), k=1) # nearest for all points
dist_km = dist_rad[:, 0] * 6371.0 # earth radius
```

A BallTree is a spatial index that makes "nearest of 72k points" fast for every one of hundreds of detections, using great-circle (haversine) distance on the sphere.

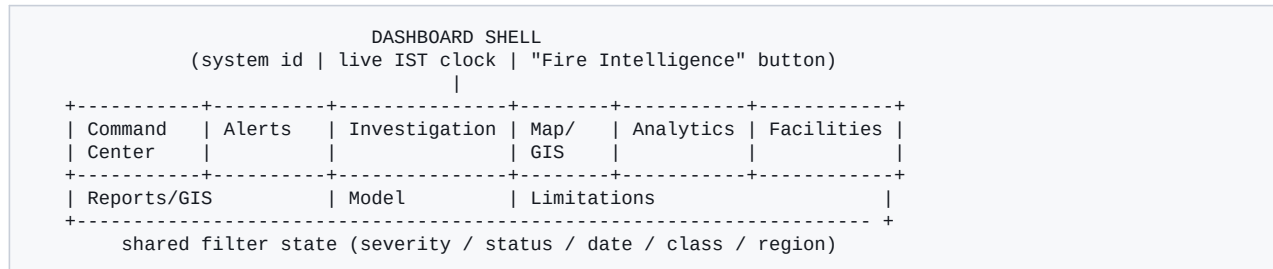
JUDGE QUESTION

Q: How do you know a facility is nearby / that it's the right one?

A: We take the single nearest facility from a 72,624-row table (power plants + OSM industrial land use) using a haversine BallTree, and we report its type and distance. It is context, not proof — a hotspot 300 m from a refinery is more suspicious, but proximity alone is never treated as a label.

Part 13 — Dashboard

[IMPLEMENTED] today: one Streamlit page (`dashboard/app.py`, ~1,760 lines) = situation header + control bar + alert feed + India map + 6 tabs (Timeline, GIS Export, Classification, Incidents, Model, Limitations). [PLANNED]: split into the sections below via `st.navigation`, same features, clearer layout.



Section	Question it answers	Shows	Operator can	Status
Command Center	What's happening, how bad, where, what needs attention?	Situation counts, live map, top-5 priority alerts, 14-day activity strip	Jump to an investigation; View All Alerts	[PLANNED] (parts exist)
Alerts	Which alerts, in what order?	Full feed, severity-grouped, paginated, filters	Filter; expand; Acknowledge / Escalate / Resolve; View Investigation	[IMPLEMENTED] feed
Investigation	Why does THIS alert matter?	Detection / context / why-flagged / classification / risk factors / recommended action	Acknowledge / Escalate / Resolve; Show on Map	[PLANNED]
Map / GIS	Where are the anomalies?	India pydeck map, class/severity colour, incident + facility layers, legend, tooltips	Zoom, toggle layers, click a detection -> Investigation	[IMPLEMENTED] map
Analytics	How does now compare to before?	Activity strip, calendar, period stats, playback, class/land-cover tables, [PLANNED] baseline FRP	Pick a date/range -> filters map & alerts	[IMPLEMENTED] + [PLANNED] baseline
Facilities	What's happening around known industry?	Facilities with nearby detections: type, state, counts, max risk	Filter map/alerts to a facility	[PLANNED]
Reports / GIS	Get the picture out	GeoJSON + CSV export (filter-aware) + preview; [PLANNED] incident report	Download artefacts	[IMPLEMENTED] export
Model	How does the system work?	Real pipeline diagram, 3-way evaluation, feature importance	Read	[IMPLEMENTED] content
Limitations	What can't it do?	FIRMS resolution, revisit, land-cover, NRT-only, framing	Read	[IMPLEMENTED] content

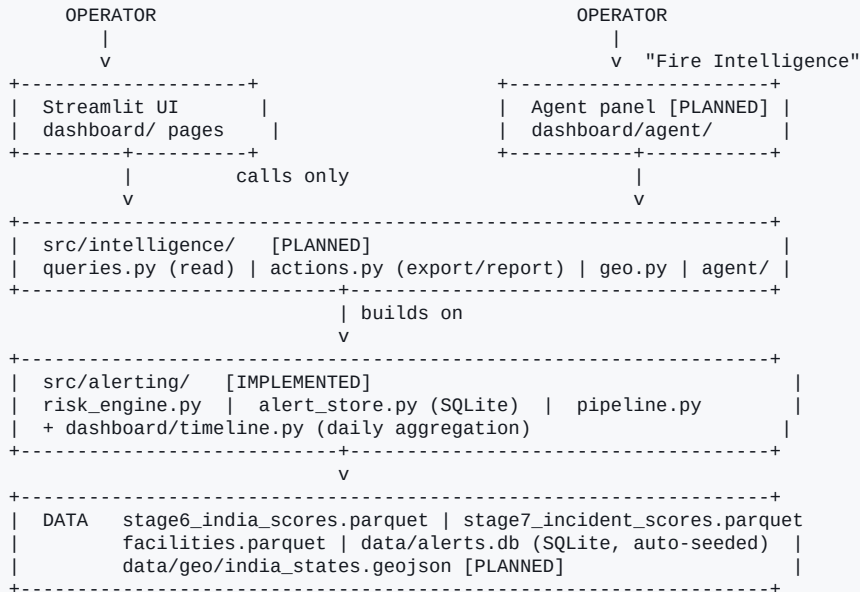
Streamlit — only what you need to know

- Streamlit re-runs the whole script top-to-bottom on every interaction.
- State that must survive a re-run lives in `st.session_state` (filters, current page, selected alert, agent history). [PLANNED] `dashboard/state.py` centralises this.
- `@st.cache_data` stops us re-reading parquet files every re-run.
- The map is pydeck (`deck.gl`) via `st.pydeck_chart`.
- On first launch, if `data/alerts.db` is missing, `pipeline.run(fresh=True)` seeds it automatically.

REMEMBER

Manual and agent paths both write the SAME session_state filters, so "agent filtered the map" and "I filtered the map" are identical downstream.

Part 14 — Application Architecture



- **UI layer** — draws things, holds no logic. Today one file; [PLANNED] multipage.
- **src/intelligence/** [PLANNED] — the single place both the UI and the agent get data. Framework-agnostic (no Streamlit import) so a React frontend could be added later untouched.
- **src/alerting/** [IMPLEMENTED] — the engines: risk scoring, the SQLite alert store + lifecycle, the seeding pipeline.
- **Data** — committed parquets (model already scored) + a local SQLite DB. The dashboard never loads the ML model file (`stage6_model.joblib` is git-ignored).

REMEMBER

ONE-MINUTE ARCHITECTURE: "An offline pipeline scores NASA FIRMS detections and writes parquet files. A rule-based engine turns those into risk-scored alerts in a small SQLite database with a lifecycle. A Streamlit dashboard reads everything through one service layer, `src/intelligence`, and shows a map, an alert feed, and per-alert investigations. A read-only Fire Intelligence Agent [PLANNED] sits on the same service layer: it turns a plain-English question into a call to those same functions and pushes the answer back into the dashboard's shared filter state. Nothing needs an internet connection or an API key to run."

Part 15 — Fire Intelligence Agent

[PLANNED]. The **guaranteed baseline is the deterministic offline parser** — no API, no network. Claude is [OPTIONAL].

```
USER QUESTION    "Show me critical industrial fires in Gujarat."
|
INTENT DETECTION  -> list / filter alerts   (verb: "show me")
|
ENTITY EXTRACTION severity = CRITICAL
|                      output_class = Industrial Fire
|                      location  = Gujarat   (from geo.REGIONS / state list)
|
TOOL SELECTION    queries.list_alerts(filters=...)
|
QUERY REAL DATA   src/intelligence -> src/alerting -> alerts.db + parquet
|
RESULT            list of real alerts (or "none match")
|
RESPONSE          short NL answer + result cards
|                  [Open Investigation] [Show on Map] [Generate Report]
|
UI ACTION         ui_action = {nav:"map", filters:{severity:["CRITICAL"],
|                      state:"Gujarat", output_class:["Industrial Fire..."]}}
|                      -> written to session_state -> st.rerun()
```

Sentence breakdown

Fragment	Becomes
"Show me"	intent = list/filter + navigate
"critical"	filters.severity = ['CRITICAL']
"industrial fires"	filters.output_class = ['Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event']
"in Gujarat"	filters.state = 'Gujarat'

Parts of the agent

- **deterministic.py** — regex/keyword intent + entity extraction. The always-on baseline.
- **tools.py** — a fixed registry of READ-ONLY tools (1:1 with `queries.py` + export/report). No state-changing tool is registered.
- **queries.py** — the real data functions (`list_alerts`, `rank_alerts`, `situation_summary`, `compare_regions`, `get_investigation`, `facilities_with_activity`, `analytics_summary`, `baseline_comparison`, `incidents`).
- **result cards** — Open Investigation / Show on Map / Generate Report buttons attached to an answer.
- **ui_action** — {nav, filters, focus_alert_id} applied through `state.py`, then `st.rerun()`.
- **shared state** — the agent writes the same filters a human would.
- **read-only security** — see Part 16.

[OPTIONAL] Claude integration

If `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` is set AND `import anthropic` works, `runtime.py` uses a Claude tool-use loop (model `claude-sonnet-5`) over the *same read-only tool registry*. It can do nothing the deterministic parser cannot. Any failure (no key, timeout, network, quota) -> silent fallback to the deterministic parser + an "offline mode" note. **The app never depends on Claude.**

REMEMBER

Agent = a natural-language interface to our existing intelligence, NOT a replacement for the intelligence. It calls the same functions the buttons call.

Part 16 — Security / Why the Agent Is Read-Only

The agent CAN	The agent CANNOT
Query alerts / detections / facilities	Modify the database
Filter, rank, aggregate, compare regions	Execute SQL or arbitrary code
Navigate to a section	Run shell commands
Focus / filter the existing map	Change an alert's status (Acknowledge / Escalate / Resolve)
Open an investigation	Delete or create alerts
Generate a GeoJSON / CSV / incident report	Re-run the pipeline or retrain the model

- The LLM (or parser) can only call **named tools with typed arguments** from a fixed registry — there is no free-form query surface.
- No state-changing tool is registered this round. `actions.set_alert_status` exists but is called **only by the manual UI buttons**.
- Worst case of a bad/hallucinated agent request: a wrong-but-harmless list or filter. Nothing is written.
- Only the [OPTIONAL] Claude path makes any network call, and it sends only the question text + tool schemas/results — never credentials or bulk data.

REMEMBER

Read-only = the agent can help you look, never touch. Consequential actions stay human. This is a deliberate safety decision for the internal hackathon.

Part 17 — End-to-End Example

One detection, traced through the whole system. Field names are real; the specific values are an **illustrative example**.

```
SATELLITE      Suomi-NPP / NOAA-20 VIIRS overpass at night sees a hot 375 m pixel
|
NASA FIRMS     row: latitude=20.31, longitude=86.61, bright_ti4=331, frp=9.5,
               acq_date=2026-08-26, daynight=N, confidence=nominal
|
INGEST/CLEAN   src/ingestion/firms.py -> tagged split=india_holdout; tidy row
|
FEATURES       bt_kelvin=331, frp_mw=9.5, persistence_count=4,
(engineer.py)  dist_nearest_facility_km=0.8, agri_season_flag=0,
               day_night_bin=0, acq_month=8
|
FACILITY CTX   nearest_facility_type="refinery" -> hazard "Oil Refinery /
               Petrochemical"; land_cover_context="Industrial Land Use"
|
ML (RF)        predict_proba -> prob_A=0.52, prob_B_candidate=0.48
               predicted_label="A"
|
ANOMALY        max(prob)=0.52 < 0.55 -> anomaly_flag = 1
|
OUTPUT CLASS   anomaly_flag==1 -> "Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event"
|
RISK ENGINE    +30 anomaly, +8 FRP(>=5), +20 persistence(>=4), +20 facility(<1),
               +10 pred=='A', +5 night, +10 near city = 103 -> shown 100
|
SEVERITY       >= 65 -> CRITICAL
|
ALERT STORE    alert_store.insert_alerts -> new row in data/alerts.db,
               status = ALERTED (because CRITICAL), narrative auto-written
|
DASHBOARD     appears top of the Alerts feed (sorted by risk_score DESC),
               red marker on the India map
|
INVESTIGATION  [PLANNED page] why-flagged: repeat detections / near industrial
               facility / industrial land-use / night-time / pattern anomaly;
               recommended action: ESCALATE FOR FIELD VERIFICATION
|
AGENT [PLANNED] "highest-risk industrial fire in Odisha?" -> queries.rank_alerts
               -> returns THIS alert -> [Open Investigation] [Show on Map]
```

REMEMBER

If you can narrate this one chain end to end, you can present the whole project.

Part 18 — What Is Actually Implemented?

Tag	Meaning
[IMPLEMENTED]	Works today in the repo you can run right now.
[PLANNED]	In the approved plan / architecture.md, not yet coded.
[OPTIONAL]	Works only if an extra thing (e.g. an API key) is present; not required.
[NOT SUPPORTED]	Deliberately excluded. Must never be claimed.

Component	Status	What it actually does
FIRMS + VNF + facility ingestion (Stages 1-2)	[IMPLEMENTED]	Downloads and tags data; builds facilities.parquet (72,624 rows).
Feature engineering (Stage 4)	[IMPLEMENTED]	features_stage4.parquet, ~419k rows, 25 cols.
Spatial split + leakage checks (Stage 5)	[IMPLEMENTED]	1-degree grid 80/20 split; assertions block India in train/val.
Random Forest train + 3-way eval (Stage 6)	[IMPLEMENTED]	Model + stage6_india_scores.parquet + reports/stage6_evaluation.txt.
Incident scoring (Stage 7)	[IMPLEMENTED]	30 incidents scored; 21/30 anomaly-flagged; stage7_incident_scores.parquet.
Risk engine	[IMPLEMENTED]	risk_engine.py: output_class, risk_score, severity, land_cover, hazard type, narrative, city context.
Alert store + lifecycle (SQLite)	[IMPLEMENTED]	alert_store.py: insert/get/update_status/counts; 6 lifecycle states.
Seeding pipeline	[IMPLEMENTED]	pipeline.run(fresh=) seeds alerts.db from scores; auto-runs on first launch.
Single-page Streamlit dashboard	[IMPLEMENTED]	app.py: header, control bar, alert feed, India map, 6 tabs.
India map (pydeck + Carto dark)	[IMPLEMENTED]	class/severity colour, incident overlay, facility toggle, tooltips.
Historical timeline / calendar / playback	[IMPLEMENTED]	timeline.py + Timeline tab; daily severity aggregation over alerts.db.
GIS export (GeoJSON + CSV)	[IMPLEMENTED]	GIS Export tab; Point features with full attribute table.
Manual Acknowledge / Escalate / Resolve	[IMPLEMENTED]	Buttons in the alert expander -> alert_store.update_status.
Model + Limitations transparency panels	[IMPLEMENTED]	Tabs describing the real pipeline and caveats.
src/intelligence/ service + tool layer	[PLANNED]	queries.py / actions.py / geo.py — one place UI + agent get data.
Multipage IA (Command Center, Investigation, Facilities, Reports pages)	[PLANNED]	Reorganise the same features via st.navigation.
lat/lon -> Indian state / region resolver	[PLANNED]	geo.py + bundled india_states.geojson, pure-Python point-in-polygon.
Investigation view (assembled)	[PLANNED]	get_investigation(alert_id): detection/context/why/risk/action.
Facilities activity view	[PLANNED]	facilities_with_activity: facilities with nearby detections + counts.
Baseline-vs-current FRP comparison	[PLANNED]	baseline_comparison(); shows 'insufficient history' when data is thin.
Risk factor breakdown in RiskResult	[PLANNED]	Additive (reason,+points) list for the Investigation risk section.

Component	Status	What it actually does
Fire Intelligence Agent (deterministic, read-only)	[PLANNED]	NL query -> tool call -> real data -> answer + result cards + ui_action.
Claude API agent runtime	[OPTIONAL]	Used only if ANTHROPIC_API_KEY set; same read-only tools; silent fallback.
Agent Acknowledge / Escalate / Resolve	[NOT SUPPORTED]	Deliberately deferred. Agent never changes incident state this round.
Confirmed-industrial-fire detection claim	[NOT SUPPORTED]	No such dataset exists; we detect anomalous departures, not confirmed fires.
Historical FIRMS archive / GIHS / land-cover raster	[NOT SUPPORTED]	Not integrated; land cover is a coordinate-zone heuristic.
Real-time streaming / auth / notifications	[NOT SUPPORTED]	Out of scope; FIRMS NRT batch + single-user local app.

Part 19 — Limitations (be honest)

Limitation	Why it exists	How to explain it to judges
No 'confirmed fire' claim	No dataset of confirmed industrial fires exists anywhere (checked: PESO, NDMA, NCRB, DGMS, CPCB, no global equivalent).	"We detect anomalous departures from known persistent-industrial and natural-fire patterns — a screening tool for human verification, not a fire confirmation system."
FIRMS resolution	VIIRS pixels are 375 m, MODIS 1 km — small or short-lived events can be missed or merged.	"We inherit the sensor's spatial limits; our value is the interpretation layer on top."
Satellite revisit / clouds	Polar-orbiting satellites pass a few times a day; cloud blocks the IR view.	"Coverage is periodic, not continuous — persistence is measured over available passes."
NRT only (~5 days)	FIRMS NRT API returns only the last ~5 days; no historical archive is wired in.	"Our timeline depth and 2019-2023 incident date-matching are limited; the archive is a known next step."
Proxy labels	'A' = near a VIIRS Nightfire flare site; 'B_candidate' = everything else global. Not human-verified.	"Labels are a defensible proxy from an authoritative flare catalogue, and we say so openly."
Thin Class A / low F1	~1,900 positive training rows -> spatial-holdout Class A F1 = 0.18.	"Minority-class recall is limited by label scarcity; a historical archive or GHS would improve it."
Land cover is a heuristic	No MODIS/ESA land-cover raster integrated; we use lat-lon zone rules.	"A pragmatic approximation; a real raster is a drop-in improvement."
Baseline comparison often empty	Needs many historical days; NRT gives ~5.	"We show it only when the data supports it, otherwise we say 'insufficient history' rather than fake a number."
Incident thermal features imputed	No historical FIRMS for 2019-2023, so bt/frp/persistence/day-night are NaN -> median-imputed.	"Incident scores are geographic-context baselines, not event classifications."
Agent is read-only	Deliberate safety choice for the hackathon.	"The agent helps you look; a human still makes every state change."
Offline / single machine	By design — must run with no network, no keys.	"Reliability for a live demo beats a cloud dependency."

Part 20 — Judge Questions (FAQ)

Problem

Q: What problem does SIH26162 solve?

Short: Satellites see heat but not cause; we classify industrial vs natural thermal events over India and deliver it as GIS.

Deeper: The raw FIRMS feed can't tell a refinery flare from a refinery fire from crop burning. We add context, classification, risk and a map so an operator can prioritise and investigate.

Q: Who is this for?

Short: Disaster-management and industrial-safety monitoring analysts.

Deeper: Also environmental-compliance teams and technical evaluators. The dashboard is designed as an operations tool, not a report.

Q: Why is industrial context central?

Short: The meaning of a hotspot depends on what's near it.

Deeper: Distance-to-facility is our top model feature (0.29) and a major risk signal; it's how we separate industrial relevance from a forest fire.

Data

Q: Where does your data come from?

Short: NASA FIRMS (thermal), VIIRS Nightfire (flare labels), WRI GPPD + OpenStreetMap (facilities).

Deeper: FIRMS NRT for India + 6 non-India training regions; VNF as a labelling oracle; 72,624 facilities; 30 curated incidents for independent evaluation.

Q: Can this work in real time?

Short: Near-real-time — FIRMS NRT updates every few hours; we run in batches.

Deeper: The pipeline is batch today. Streaming ingestion is out of scope but the architecture (score -> parquet -> alert store) would extend to it.

Q: Why hold India out of training?

Short: So the model learns physics, not Indian locations.

Deeper: Global training + India geographic holdout tests whether learned thermal patterns generalise to India — a stronger claim than memorising Indian facilities. India is still used for context, evaluation and deployment.

Q: What if there's no historical data?

Short: We degrade honestly — features are imputed and we say so.

Deeper: FIRMS NRT is ~5 days. For the 2019-2023 incidents, thermal features are NaN -> median-imputed, so those scores are geographic-context baselines, not event classifications. The timeline shows only what's in alerts.db.

ML

Q: Why Random Forest, not deep learning?

Short: 7 tabular features, tiny positive class, explainability required.

Deeper: Trees need no scaling, handle imbalance with class weights, expose feature importance, and don't overfit ~1,900 positives the way a CNN would. A CNN also needs image inputs we don't have.

Q: Why not a CNN on satellite imagery?

Short: We don't ingest imagery, and there's no labelled image dataset of industrial fires.

Deeper: FIRMS gives tabular detections. Building a CNN would mean sourcing and labelling raster scenes — infeasible and unnecessary for 7 features.

Q: What are your labels?

Short: A = FIRMS row within 5 km of a VIIRS Nightfire flare site; B_candidate = other global FIRMS.

Deeper: Proxy labels from an authoritative flare catalogue. No confirmed-incident labels are used for training — none exist.

Q: How accurate is it?

Short: ~98% overall accuracy, but the honest metric is Class A F1 = 0.18 on spatial holdout.

Deeper: Overall accuracy is inflated by the easy majority class. We report all three evaluations and the leakage gap openly.

Q: What does anomaly_flag mean?

Short: The forest couldn't reach 55% confidence for either class.

Deeper: $\max(\text{prob_A}, \text{prob_B_candidate}) < 0.55$. Those rows become 'Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event' — a human-review candidate, not a conclusion.

Q: How do you prevent data leakage?

Short: Split by 1-degree spatial grid cells, not randomly; India fully held out; assertions in code.

Deeper: Repeated detections from one site can't span train/val. `check_no_india_in_training` and `check_no_grid_overlap` raise `LeakageError` if violated.

Risk

Q: How is risk calculated?

Short: A transparent additive rule engine, 0-100, then banded into severity.

Deeper: Points for anomaly (+30), FRP, persistence, facility proximity, predicted class, FIRMS confidence, night, city proximity. ≥ 65 CRITICAL, ≥ 40 HIGH, ≥ 20 MEDIUM, else LOW. All in `risk_engine.py`.

Q: Is risk the same as the ML output?

Short: No. ML says what it is; risk says how concerning it is.

Deeper: A correctly-classified routine flare can be LOW risk; an anomaly near a chemical plant is CRITICAL. Different code, different purpose.

Q: Why a rule engine and not ML for risk?

Short: Transparency and control — every point is explainable to a judge and an operator.

Deeper: We can show exactly which signals drove a score. There's also no labelled 'risk' target to learn from.

GIS

Q: How do you know a facility is nearby?

Short: Nearest-neighbour search over 72,624 facilities with a haversine BallTree.

Deeper: We report the single closest facility's type and great-circle distance. Context, never a label.

Q: How do you distinguish industrial fire from wildfire?

Short: Persistence + industrial proximity + land-cover zone + night behaviour + the RF pattern.

Deeper: A wildfire is bursty, often in forest/cropland, far from industry; a persistent source re-lights every pass near a facility. The model weighs these; the risk engine and land-cover context reinforce it.

Q: What is GeoJSON and why export it?

Short: A standard geographic JSON; each alert is a Point with attributes.

Deeper: So analysts can open our alerts in QGIS/ArcGIS. That's PS deliverable (ii): a GIS-based solution.

Dashboard

Q: Walk me through the operator workflow.

Short: Command Center -> Alerts -> Investigation -> act; Map and Analytics for context.

Deeper: DETECT -> CLASSIFY -> VALIDATE -> PRIORITIZE -> EXPLAIN -> ACT. Filters are shared across sections; clicking a map marker opens the investigation.

Q: Is the UI just a prototype?

Short: It's a working Streamlit app today; the multipage reorg is planned.

Deeper: Single-page app with a live map, alert feed, timeline, GIS export and manual actions all working. The plan splits it into clearer sections without removing features.

Agent

Q: Why do you need the agent?

Short: To ask the platform instead of driving many filters by hand.

Deeper: It's a second interface over the same intelligence layer — a judge can ask 'highest-risk persistent sources near industry in eastern India, last 7 days' and get ranked, explained results with one-click navigation.

Q: Why is the agent offline / does it need an API key?

Short: No. The deterministic parser is the guaranteed baseline; Claude is optional.

Deeper: Everything runs with no network and no key. If ANTHROPIC_API_KEY is present the Claude runtime is used over the same read-only tools, with silent fallback on any failure.

Q: Can the agent change alerts?

Short: No — it is strictly read-only.

Deeper: It can query, filter, navigate, focus the map, open investigations and generate reports. It cannot Acknowledge/Escalate/Resolve, run SQL, or touch the database. Consequential actions stay human.

Q: Is the agent just a chatbot wrapper?

Short: No — it calls the exact functions the dashboard buttons call.

Deeper: Natural language -> intent + entities -> a named read-only tool in src/intelligence -> real data -> answer + result cards that drive the shared UI state.

Security / Validation

Q: What stops the agent doing something dangerous?

Short: It can only call a fixed registry of read-only tools with typed arguments.

Deeper: No free-form query surface, no SQL/shell/eval, no state-changing tool registered. Worst case is a wrong list, never a write.

Q: How do you validate the whole system?

Short: Unit tests for ingestion/features/split today; planned tests for the service + agent layer; the 3-way model evaluation.

Deeper: tests/ has 49 passing tests for leakage and features. Planned: geo, queries, actions, deterministic-parser tests. Model: random vs spatial vs India holdout.

Limitations / Future

Q: Biggest weakness?

Short: Label scarcity for the industrial class (Class A F1 = 0.18).

Deeper: Only ~1,900 positive examples via the VNF oracle. A historical FIRMS archive or the GIHS dataset would materially help recall.

Q: What would you add next?

Short: Historical FIRMS archive, then GIHS + a land-cover raster, then agent actions with confirmation.

Deeper: Archive unlocks real temporal incident matching and a deeper baseline. GIHS + raster improve classification. Agent write-actions are a deliberate later step behind a confirmation gate.

Q: Could this deploy for real?

Short: The intelligence layer could; it's built to be frontend-agnostic.

Deeper: src/intelligence has no UI dependency, so a FastAPI + React front end could sit on it. Real deployment also needs the archive, auth and streaming.

Part 21 — 30-second / 1-minute / 3-minute Explanations

30 seconds (problem + solution)

EXAMPLE

"NASA's FIRMS satellites detect heat anywhere on Earth but can't say what's burning. Over an industrial region that matters — a refinery flare and a refinery fire look the same from orbit. We enrich every detection with industrial and geographic context, classify it with a Random Forest trained on global data with India held out, flag the uncertain ones as anomalies, score the risk, and present prioritised, explained alerts on a GIS dashboard."

1 minute (+ architecture + differentiation)

EXAMPLE

"[30-second version] ... Under the hood: an offline pipeline scores FIRMS detections and writes parquet files; a transparent rule engine turns those into risk-scored alerts in a SQLite store with a full lifecycle; a Streamlit dashboard shows a live India map, an alert feed, and per-alert investigations that explain WHY each alert was flagged. What makes it different: we're honest that no confirmed-fire dataset exists, so we frame it as anomaly screening; we prevent spatial leakage and hold India out entirely; and there's an optional read-only natural-language agent over the same intelligence layer. It all runs offline with no API key."

3 minutes (full technical story)

EXAMPLE

"The problem statement asks us to separate industrial fires and persistent industrial thermal sources from natural and agricultural fires, as a GIS solution. The catch, which we researched first, is that no dataset of confirmed industrial fires exists anywhere, and a FIRMS hotspot carries no cause label. So we don't claim fire detection.

Data: FIRMS near-real-time detections for India plus six non-India regions for training; the VIIRS Nightfire flare catalogue as a labelling oracle; 72,624 industrial facilities from WRI and OpenStreetMap. We label a global FIRMS row 'A' (persistent industrial source) if it's within 5 km of a known flare site, else 'B_candidate' (natural/agricultural). We engineer 7 features: brightness temperature, FRP, persistence count, distance to nearest facility, agri-season, day/night, month.

Model: a Random Forest, 300 trees, class-balanced, median imputation. We evaluate three ways — a random split (0.97, inflated), a spatial-grid holdout (0.98 overall but Class A F1 only 0.18, the honest number), and the India geographic holdout where 8.4% of detections are flagged as anomalies. If the forest can't reach 55% confidence for either class, we flag the detection as an anomaly for human review.

Then a separate rule-based risk engine scores 0-100 from anomaly status, FRP, persistence, facility proximity, night, and city proximity, and bands it CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW. Alerts go into a SQLite store with a six-state lifecycle. The Streamlit dashboard shows a situation overview, an India map, the alert feed, a historical timeline, GIS export, and — planned — a dedicated Investigation view that lists exactly which signals fired. An optional read-only Fire Intelligence Agent lets you ask all of this in plain English; it calls the same functions the buttons do and can never change state. Everything runs offline."

Part 22 — Memory Sheets

Cheat Sheet 1 — Whole project in 10 lines

```
1 Goal: separate industrial fires / persistent industrial sources from natural fires; deliver as GIS.
2 Data: NASA FIRMS NRT (India + 6 global regions), VIIRS Nightfire, 72,624 facilities (WRI+OSM).
3 Labels: proxy. A = FIRMS within 5km of a VNF flare site; B_candidate = other global FIRMS.
4 Features (7): bt_kelvin, frp_mw, persistence_count, dist_nearest_facility_km, agri_season_flag,
  day_night_bin, acq_month.
5 Model: RandomForest 300 trees, class_weight=balanced, median impute. Predicts A vs B_candidate.
6 Anomaly: max(prob) < 0.55 -> anomaly_flag = 1 -> "Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event".
7 Eval: random 0.9725 (inflated) | spatial holdout 0.9806, Class A F1 0.18 (honest) | India 8.4% anomaly.
8 Risk engine (rules, 0-100): anomaly+30, FRP, persistence, facility dist, night, city -> severity band.
9 Alerts: SQLite, lifecycle DETECTED->VALIDATING->ALERTED->ESCALATED->MONITORING->EXTINGUISHED.
10 UI: Streamlit + pydeck India map + alert feed + timeline + GIS export. Agent [PLANNED], read-only, offline.
```

Cheat Sheet 2 — Data pipeline

```
ACQUIRE -> INGEST(tag split) -> CLEAN -> FEATURES(7) -> FACILITY CTX(BallTree)
-> CLASSIFY(RF) -> ANOMALY(0.55) -> RISK(rules) -> ALERT(SQLite)
Files: src/ingestion/* , src/features/engineer.py , src/model/{assemble,train,split}.py ,
      src/alerting/{risk_engine,alert_store,pipeline}.py
Outputs committed: stage6_india_scores.parquet, stage7_incident_scores.parquet, facilities.parquet
NOT in repo: stage6_model.joblib, stage5_*.parquet, data/raw/ (all git-ignored)
```

Cheat Sheet 3 — ML

```
Target : 2 classes A (persistent industrial) vs B_candidate (natural/agri)
Labels : VNF spatial oracle, 5 km radius. No confirmed-fire labels.
Samples: train 270,238 (A=1,655) | val 64,864 (A=246) | India holdout 705 (no labels)
Model : Pipeline(SimpleImputer(median), RandomForestClassifier(
  n_estimators=300, min_samples_leaf=10, class_weight='balanced', random_state=42))
Outputs: predicted_label, prob_A, prob_B_candidate, anomaly_flag(=max(prob)<0.55)
Feat.imp: dist_facility .29 | day_night .25 | bt_kelvin .21 | persistence .14 | frp .10 | month 0 | agri 0
Never claims: "confirmed industrial fire"
```

Cheat Sheet 4 — Risk

```
score = 0
+30 anomaly_flag==1
+25/+15/+8 frp_mw >=30 / >=15 / >=5
+20/+10 persistence_count >=4 / >=2
+20/+12/+6 dist_nearest_facility_km <1 / <5 / <15
+10 predicted_label=='A'
+8 FIRMS confidence high
+5 night
+10 nearest city <30 km
severity: >=65 CRITICAL | >=40 HIGH | >=20 MEDIUM | <20 LOW
also outputs: land_cover_context, hazard_facility_type, narrative, nearest_city
```

Cheat Sheet 5 — GIS

```
Point data (lat, lon) per detection/alert.
Nearest facility: BallTree(metric='haversine') over 72,624 rows -> type + distance_km.
Map: pydeck ScatterplotLayer, Carto dark basemap, colour by class or severity.
Export: GeoJSON FeatureCollection (Point + full attributes) + CSV. = PS deliverable (ii).
[PLANNED] state/region: point-in-polygon vs bundled india_states.geojson; 'eastern india' region set.
```

Cheat Sheet 6 — Dashboard

```
Today: 1 Streamlit page (dashboard/app.py) = header + control bar + alert feed + India map
      + tabs {Timeline, GIS Export, Classification, Incidents, Model, Limitations}
[PLANNED] pages: Command Center | Alerts | Investigation | Map/GIS | Analytics |
               Facilities | Reports/GIS | Model | Limitations (via st.navigation)
```

Shared session_state filters: severity / status / date / class / region
Manual actions (IMPLEMENTED): Acknowledge->MONITORING, Escalate->ESCALATED, Resolve->EXTINGUISHED
First run auto-seeds data/alerts.db via pipeline.run(fresh=True)

Cheat Sheet 7 — Agent [PLANNED]

question -> intent + entities (severity/class/region/timeframe/rank)
-> named READ-ONLY tool in src/intelligence/agent/tools.py
-> queries.py (real data) -> answer + result cards + ui_action
Result cards: [Open Investigation] [Show on Map] [Generate Report]
ui_action {nav, filters, focus_alert_id} -> session_state -> st.rerun()
Baseline: deterministic.py (offline, no key). [OPTIONAL] claude.py (claude-sonnet-5), silent fallback.
Read-only: no DB write, no SQL, no shell, no status change.

Cheat Sheet 8 — Judge one-liners

"Is this a confirmed fire?" -> No. Anomalous departure from known patterns; needs human check.
"Why Random Forest?" -> 7 tabular features, tiny positive class, explainability.
"What are your labels?" -> Proxy: near a VIIRS Nightfire flare site = A; else B_candidate.
"How accurate?" -> ~98% overall (inflated); honest Class A F1 = 0.18 spatial holdout.
"Model uncertain?" -> max(prob)<0.55 -> anomaly_flag -> human review.
"How is risk different?" -> ML = what it is; risk engine = how concerning (rules, 0-100).
"Nearest facility?" -> haversine BallTree over 72,624 facilities.
"Does the agent need internet?" -> No. Deterministic offline parser is the baseline.
"Can the agent change alerts?" -> No. Strictly read-only.
"Real time?" -> Near-real-time FIRMS, batch pipeline.

Cheat Sheet 9 — Numbers, files, modules

Thing	Value / path
India bbox	lat 6.0-37.0, lon 68.0-97.5 (src/model/split.py)
Facilities	72,624 (34,936 WRI GPPD + 37,688 OSM); ~39,277 in India
Train / Val / India rows	270,238 / 64,864 / 705
Class A training rows	1,655 train + 246 val = 1,901 (~0.57%)
RF hyperparams	n_estimators=300, min_samples_leaf=10, class_weight='balanced', random_state=42
Anomaly threshold	0.55 (train.py:59, score_incidents.py:46)
VNF oracle radius	5.0 km (assemble.py:57)
Severity cutoffs	65 / 40 / 20
Incidents scored	30; anomaly-flagged 21 (70%)
India predictions	A=309, B_candidate=396, anomaly 59 (8.4%)
Model file	data/processed/stage6_model.joblib – GIT-IGNORED, not in repo
Dashboard entry	dashboard/app.py (streamlit run dashboard/app.py)
Alert DB	data/alerts.db (SQLite, auto-seeded, git-ignored)
Risk engine	src/alerting/risk_engine.py
Alert store	src/alerting/alert_store.py
Docs	context.md, architecture.md, workflow.md, design_brief.md, modeltrain.md

Part 23 — Master Memory Palace

Icon / role	Analogy	Technical reality (do not distort this)
Eyes	SATELLITE — sees heat	NASA FIRMS VIIRS/MODIS thermal-anomaly detections (lat, lon, FRP, BT, time)
Brain	ML — decides what it is	RandomForest -> predicted_label (A / B_candidate) + probabilities + anomaly_flag
Threat board	RISK ENGINE — how worried to be	rule-based additive score 0-100 -> severity band (separate from ML)
Map	GIS — where + what's nearby	pydeck India map, haversine nearest-facility, land-cover zone, GeoJSON export
Notebook	ALERT MEMORY — what we've seen	SQLite alerts.db with a 6-state lifecycle
Control room	DASHBOARD — where the operator works	Streamlit app: situation view, feed, map, timeline, investigation
Assistant	AGENT — answers questions	[PLANNED] read-only NL interface over the same src/intelligence functions

EYES (satellite)	NASA FIRMS thermal detection
BRAIN (ML)	RandomForest -> label + prob + anomaly_flag
THREAT BOARD (risk)	rule engine 0-100 -> CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW
MAP (GIS)	coordinates + nearest facility + land-cover + map
NOTEBOOK (alert memory)	SQLite alerts.db + lifecycle
CONTROL ROOM (dashboard)	Streamlit: feed + map + timeline + investigation
ASSISTANT (agent) [PLANNED]	NL question -> read-only tools -> same data

REMEMBER

Eyes -> Brain -> Threat board -> Map -> Notebook -> Control room -> Assistant. Seven links. If you can say the technical name for each icon, you know the system.

Part 24 — Final Self-Test (50 questions)

Answers start on the next page. Cover them first.

1. [L1] State the project goal in one sentence.
2. [L1] What does NASA FIRMS give you, and what does it NOT give you?
3. [L1] Name the three output classes shown on the dashboard.
4. [L1] What is the difference between classification and risk?
5. [L1] What does 'GIS solution' mean for PS deliverable (ii)?
6. [L1] Which two data sources give the facility layer?
7. [L1] What runs when you first launch the dashboard with no alerts.db?
8. [L1] Does the project need an internet connection or API key to run?
9. [L1] Name the 6 alert lifecycle states in order.
10. [L1] What is the one-sentence 'master memory' chain?
11. [L2] List the 7 model features.
12. [L2] How are the training labels ('A' / 'B_candidate') created?
13. [L2] How many train / val / India-holdout rows are there?
14. [L2] What model and hyperparameters are used?
15. [L2] Define anomaly_flag precisely.
16. [L2] List the risk-engine point rules from memory.
17. [L2] What are the severity cutoffs?
18. [L2] How is nearest-facility distance computed?
19. [L2] What does the risk engine output besides the score?
20. [L2] Which fields does the Investigation view assemble, in order?
21. [L2] What does the [PLANNED] state/region resolver do and how?
22. [L2] What are the agent's result cards and ui_action?
23. [L2] Where does the dashboard get its data from (which layer)?
24. [L2] What is committed to the repo vs git-ignored, data-wise?
25. [L2] What are the three model evaluations and their headline numbers?
26. [L3] Why Random Forest instead of a neural network?
27. [L3] Why hold India out of training entirely?
28. [L3] Why split by spatial grid instead of randomly?
29. [L3] Why is overall accuracy (0.98) misleading here?
30. [L3] Why is facility proximity a feature but never a label?
31. [L3] Why is risk a rule engine and not another ML model?
32. [L3] Why is the agent read-only for this round?
33. [L3] Why is the deterministic parser the baseline and Claude only optional?
34. [L3] Why does src/intelligence have no Streamlit import?

35. [L3] Why can't we claim 'confirmed industrial fire'?
36. [L4] A judge says '98% accuracy is great!' — correct them.
37. [L4] A judge asks 'so you can detect industrial fires?' — respond precisely.
38. [L4] 'Your Class A F1 is only 0.18, is the model useless?' — defend it.
39. [L4] 'Isn't near-a-factory basically your label?' — rebut.
40. [L4] 'Why not just use the FIRMS confidence field?' — answer.
41. [L4] 'What if the agent hallucinates and escalates a wrong alert?' — answer.
42. [L4] 'How is this different from an existing wildfire dashboard?' — answer.
43. [L4] 'Can this run at national scale in real time?' — answer honestly.
44. [L4] 'Why 0.55 and not 0.5 or 0.6 for the anomaly threshold?' — answer.
45. [L4] 'Where do the 30 incidents fit — are they training data?' — answer.
46. [L5] alerts.db is deleted mid-demo. What happens on the next page load, and which module handles it?
47. [L5] A new FIRMS row has frp=NaN. Trace how it still gets a prediction and a risk score.
48. [L5] The agent answers 'critical alerts in Odisha' but the Map doesn't change. Where are the 3 likely break points?
49. [L5] You must add a 'distance to coastline' feature. Which files change, and what must you re-run?
50. [L5] A teammate imports src.alerting directly inside a new dashboard page. Why is that a problem per the architecture, and the fix?

Self-Test — Answers

1. Take NASA FIRMS heat detections over India, add industrial + geographic context, classify each as persistent industrial source vs natural fire (flag neither-fits as anomaly), risk-score it, and raise prioritised explained alerts on a GIS dashboard.
2. Gives: lat/lon, brightness temperature, FRP, date/time, day-night, confidence. Does NOT give: the cause, a confirmed-fire label, industrial-vs-natural, history older than ~5 days, sub-pixel detail.
3. Industrial Fire / Abnormal Thermal Event; Persistent Industrial Thermal Source; Forest / Agricultural Fire.
4. Classification (ML) = WHAT the thermal event is. Risk (rule engine) = HOW CONCERNING it is. Different code, different logic.
5. Store data and show it as map overlays with exportable geographic formats (GeoJSON/CSV) usable in QGIS/ArcGIS.
6. WRI Global Power Plant Database (34,936) + OpenStreetMap landuse=industrial (37,688).
7. `pipeline.run(fresh=True)` auto-seeds `data/alerts.db` from `stage6_india_scores.parquet` (guard at the top of `dashboard/app.py`).
8. No. The whole app + deterministic agent run offline with no key. Claude is optional.
9. DETECTED -> VALIDATING -> ALERTED -> ESCALATED -> MONITORING -> EXTINGUISHED.
10. Satellite detects heat -> we collect/process -> add environmental+industrial context -> ML estimates what it is -> risk engine estimates how concerning -> GIS says where+what's nearby -> alert generated -> operator investigates -> agent helps ask questions.
11. `bt_kelvin`, `frp_mw`, `persistence_count`, `dist_nearest_facility_km`, `agri_season_flag`, `day_night_bin`, `acq_month`.
12. VNF spatial oracle: a global FIRMS row within 5 km of a known VIIRS Nightfire gas-flare site -> 'A'; every other global FIRMS row -> 'B_candidate'. VNF rows themselves are excluded from training.
13. Train 270,238 | Val 64,864 | India holdout 705 (no labels).
14. sklearn Pipeline: `SimpleImputer(strategy='median')` then `RandomForestClassifier(n_estimators=300, min_samples_leaf=10, class_weight='balanced', n_jobs=-1, random_state=42)`.
15. `anomaly_flag = int( max(prob_A, prob_B_candidate) < 0.55 )`. Applied after the forest votes.
16. +30 anomaly; +25/+15/+8 FRP>=30/15/5; +20/+10 persistence>=4/2; +20/+12/+6 facility<1/5/15 km; +10 predicted 'A'; +8 FIRMS confidence high; +5 night; +10 nearest city <30 km.
17. CRITICAL >=65, HIGH >=40, MEDIUM >=20, LOW <20.
18. `BallTree(metric='haversine')` built over facility lat/lon (radians); query `k=1` for every point; `distance_rad * 6371` km.
19. `output_class`, `severity`, `land_cover_context`, `hazard_facility_type`, `narrative`, `nearest_city`, `dist_nearest_city_km`, `near_population` (and [PLANNED] a risk-factor breakdown).
20. Incident header, Detection, Context, Why Flagged, Classification, Risk Assessment, Recommended Action.
21. [PLANNED] `geo.py`: point-in-polygon (pure Python ray-casting) against a bundled simplified `india_states.geojson` -> state name; a REGIONS map groups states (e.g. 'eastern india').
22. Result cards: Open Investigation / Show on Map / Generate Report. `ui_action = {nav, filters, focus_alert_id}`, applied via `state.py` then `st.rerun()`.
23. [PLANNED] `src/intelligence/` (`queries.py` / `actions.py` / `geo.py`) — the single service layer; the dashboard imports only that, never `src.alerting` directly.
24. Committed: `stage6_india_scores.parquet`, `stage7_incident_scores.parquet`, `facilities.parquet`, the CSVs/JSONs, [PLANNED] `india_states.geojson`. Git-ignored: `stage6_model.joblib`, `stage5_*.parquet`, `data/raw/`, `data/alerts.db`.

- 25.** Random split: accuracy 0.9725 (inflated). Spatial holdout: 0.9806 overall, Class A F1 0.18 (honest). India holdout: no labels, predicted A=309 / B_candidate=396, anomaly 59/705 = 8.4%.
- 26.** 7 tabular features, ~0.6% positive class, and explainability is required. Trees need no scaling, handle imbalance via class weights, expose feature importance. A CNN needs image inputs and far more labels than exist.
- 27.** So the model learns physical/thermal patterns, not Indian locations/facilities. It becomes a geographic-generalisation test. India is still used for context, evaluation and deployment.
- 28.** Repeated detections from the same site/cell would leak across a random split and inflate accuracy. Whole 1-degree grid cells go entirely to train or val.
- 29.** It is dominated by the huge easy majority class (B_candidate). The minority class that actually matters has F1 = 0.18.
- 30.** 'Near a facility' does not mean 'industrial fire' — refineries have forests and roads nearby too. Using it as a label would be circular. It is a context feature only.
- 31.** Transparency and control: every point is explainable to a judge/operator, and there is no labelled 'risk' target to learn from.
- 32.** Safety for a live internal demo — the agent can help you look but a human makes every consequential change. Write-actions are a deliberate later step behind confirmation.
- 33.** Offline-first: the demo must run with no network and no key. Claude adds cost/latency/network and must degrade cleanly; it can do nothing the parser can't.
- 34.** So it is framework-agnostic and reusable — a future FastAPI + React frontend could sit on the same functions without touching logic.
- 35.** No dataset of confirmed industrial fires exists (India or global), and a FIRMS hotspot has no cause label. We detect anomalous departures from known patterns — screening, not confirmation.
- 36.** 'That number is inflated by the easy majority class. Our honest metric is Class A F1 = 0.18 on a spatial holdout, and we report the leakage gap openly — the minority industrial class is hard because only ~1,900 labelled positives exist.'
- 37.** 'We flag anomalous thermal departures near industrial infrastructure for human verification. We do not and cannot confirm fires — no ground-truth dataset exists.'
- 38.** 'No — it's a screening layer. Recall is limited by label scarcity, not model choice. It still surfaces the right anomalies for review, and a historical FIRMS archive or GIHS would raise recall. The risk engine and investigation add operational value on top.'
- 39.** 'No. Proximity is one of seven features and a risk signal, never a label. Forests, farms and towns are near industry too. Labels come from the VIIRS Nightfire flare catalogue.'
- 40.** 'FIRMS confidence is a detection-quality flag, not a cause. We do use it (+8 in the risk score when high), but it can't separate industrial from natural.'
- 41.** 'It can't — it's strictly read-only. It calls a fixed registry of query-only tools; there is no state-changing tool registered, no SQL, no DB write. Worst case is a wrong list.'
- 42.** 'A wildfire dashboard shows where fires are. We add industrial context, a persistent-vs-natural classifier with an anomaly path, a transparent risk score, an explainable per-alert investigation, and a natural-language interface — all framed honestly as anomaly screening.'
- 43.** 'Near-real-time, in batches. The pipeline scores FIRMS NRT and writes parquet; the architecture would extend to streaming, but that plus auth and an archive are future work.'
- 44.** 'It's a deliberate margin: requiring $\geq 55\%$ for a confident call widens the review band so borderline events (~0.50-0.55) get human eyes. It's a fixed operational rule, tunable, not learned.'

- 45.** 'They are an independent evaluation / demo set (30 curated real incidents), NOT a training class. 21/30 land as anomalies, which is the intended behaviour — real incidents match neither learned pattern.'
- 46.** On the next load, the guard at the top of dashboard/app.py sees data/alerts.db missing and calls `src.alerting.pipeline.run(fresh=True)`, which re-scores `stage6_india_scores.parquet` through `risk_engine` and re-inserts alerts via `alert_store`. The demo self-heals.
- 47.** `frp_mw=NaN` flows into X; the Pipeline's `SimpleImputer(strategy='median')` replaces it with the training-set median before the `RandomForest` predicts -> `predicted_label + probs + anomaly_flag`. The risk engine reads `frp_mw` via `row.get('frp_mw',0)` or 0, so a missing FRP simply contributes 0 FRP points; other signals still score.
- 48.** (1) deterministic parser didn't extract `state='Odisha'` (entity extraction / `geo.REGIONS`); (2) the tool ran but `ui_action.filters` wasn't built or wasn't written through `state.py`; (3) the panel didn't call `st.rerun()` / the Map page reads a different filter key than the one written.
- 49.** Change `src/features/engineer.py` (compute the feature), `src/model/assemble.py` + `train.py` (add to `TRAIN_FEATURES`), optionally `src/scoring/score_incidents.py`. Re-run Stages 4->5->6 to regenerate `features_stage4`, `stage5_*`, the model and `stage6_india_scores.parquet`. Risk engine only changes if you want it to use the new field.
- 50.** The architecture rule is that dashboard/ imports only `src/intelligence/`, so both UI and agent share one logic layer and a future non-Streamlit frontend stays possible. Fix: add/whichever query is needed to `src/intelligence/queries.py` (or `actions.py`) and call that from the page.

Night-Before-Hackathon Cheat Sheet

Say this if you only remember one thing

THE LINE

"NASA FIRMS sees heat but not cause. We add industrial + geographic context to every detection over India, classify persistent industrial sources vs natural fires with a Random Forest (India held out of training), flag the uncertain ones as anomalies for human review, score the risk with a transparent rule engine, and show prioritised, explained alerts on a GIS dashboard. It runs offline. We never claim 'confirmed fire' — no such dataset exists."

The 7 features (memorise)

bt_kelvin | frp_mw | persistence_count | dist_nearest_facility_km | agri_season_flag | day_night_bin | acq_month

The numbers that matter

train / val / India	270,238 / 64,864 / 705
Class A rows (labels)	1,901 total (~0.57%) — this is why recall is hard
Anomaly threshold	$\max(\text{prob}) < 0.55$
Honest model metric	Class A F1 = 0.18 (spatial holdout); accuracy 0.98 is inflated
India anomaly rate	$59 / 705 = 8.4\%$
Severity cutoffs	65 / 40 / 20
Facilities	72,624 (WRI + OSM)
Incidents	30 scored, 21 anomaly-flagged — evaluation set, not training

The 6 things NOT to say

- Do NOT say "we detect industrial fires" — say "we flag anomalous thermal departures for review".
- Do NOT say "98% accurate" without adding "Class A F1 is 0.18, the honest number".
- Do NOT say the agent "does things" — it is read-only.
- Do NOT say we trained on Indian data — India is held out.
- Do NOT say "near a facility means industrial" — proximity is a feature, not a label.
- Do NOT present a [PLANNED] feature (Investigation page, Facilities page, agent) as finished — say "designed, in progress".

If a demo breaks

- Map/agent won't update -> the filter didn't reach session_state; refresh the page.
- No alerts -> delete data/alerts.db and reload; it re-seeds automatically.
- Agent gives a weird answer offline -> the deterministic parser missed an entity; rephrase with explicit words ("critical", state name, "last 7 days").
- Claude errors -> expected; it falls back to offline mode, keep going.

Three explanations, three lengths

- **30s:** problem (heat, not cause) + solution (context + RF + anomaly + risk + GIS).

- **1 min:** add the architecture (offline pipeline -> parquet -> rule engine -> SQLite alerts -> Streamlit) + differentiation (honest framing, no leakage, optional read-only agent).
- **3 min:** full story — data + proxy labels + 7 features + RF + 3-way eval + 0.55 anomaly + risk engine + lifecycle + dashboard + agent.

Final gut-check questions

Q Is this a confirmed fire?	-> No. Anomaly screening for human review.
Q Why Random Forest?	-> Tabular, tiny positive class, explainable.
Q What are your labels?	-> Proxy from VIIRS Nightfire flare sites (5 km).
Q Model uncertain?	-> $\max(\text{prob}) < 0.55$ -> anomaly_flag.
Q Classification vs risk?	-> what it is vs how concerning (rules).
Q Nearest facility?	-> haversine BallTree over 72,624 rows.
Q Agent needs internet?	-> No, deterministic offline baseline.
Q Agent can change alerts?	-> No, strictly read-only.
Q Trained on India?	-> No, India is the held-out test region.

REMEMBER

Eyes -> Brain -> Threat board -> Map -> Notebook -> Control room -> Assistant. Satellite -> ML -> Risk -> GIS -> Alert store -> Dashboard -> Agent.